

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Pharmaceutical English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For clinical development, regulatory affairs, pharmacovigilance, quality, CMC, manufacturing, medical affairs, market access, and compliance teams.

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Drug Development Strategy, Unmet Need, TPP, and Evidence Logic

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

02 Regulatory Pathways, IND Readiness, NDA/BLA Strategy, and Agency Interaction

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

03 Clinical Trial Design, Protocols, GCP, and Operations

Clarify missing information before responding.

04 Endpoints, Estimands, Statistics, Data Readouts, and Clinical Meaning

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Pharmacovigilance, Safety Signals, Risk-Benefit, and Label Updates

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

06 CMC, CGMP, Quality Events, Manufacturing, and Supply

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

07 Labeling, Medical Affairs, Promotion Review, and Compliance Boundaries

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward.

08 Market Access, RWE, Launch Readiness, Biosimilars, and Lifecycle Management

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Drug Development Strategy, Unmet Need, TPP, and Evidence Logic

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A development slide describes an early laboratory result as evidence that a product will benefit patients. Clinical benefit has not been established.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: Indication, MOA, TPP, IND.

Model response

The result supports further investigation in this laboratory setting. It does not establish patient benefit. I'll revise the wording to distinguish the early finding from the clinical questions still to be tested.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. A - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. C - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 • Conversations

1. A laboratory signal is not patient benefit - Fictional development-slide review: a laboratory result is promising, but no clinical benefit has been established.

2. Two indications, one evidence package - Separate fictional portfolio discussion: candidate P7 has laboratory data for indication A; indication B has only a biological rationale.

3. Readiness for discussion versus readiness for filing - Separate fictional project check-in: an IND planning discussion is scheduled, but the supporting evidence inventory is incomplete.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An unmet-need claim without a source

In a fictional portfolio meeting, a slide says all existing options fail patients. The team has interviewed six clinicians, but no comparative evidence review is available. Discuss wording that preserves the development rationale without claiming universal failure.

Role A: Development strategist: explain what the interviews support and propose a qualified unmet-need statement.

Role B: Medical reviewer: challenge the universal wording and ask which evidence is still needed.

Possible opening: The six interviews identify concerns, but they don't establish that every existing option fails.

Success checks

- Distinguish reported concerns from a general clinical conclusion.
- Connect the proposed indication or TPP to an unanswered evidence question.
- Agree on a spoken claim that retains the limitation.

Add a complication: The presenter wants to keep the absolute claim because the speaking slot is only one minute.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Regulatory Pathways, IND Readiness, NDA/BLA Strategy, and Agency Interaction

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A team is preparing a question for a regulatory meeting. The draft asks broadly whether the whole development plan is acceptable.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: IND, NDA, BLA, Complete response letter.

Model response

Could we identify the specific issue, proposed approach, and evidence supporting it? A focused question will make the requested feedback clearer than asking for general approval of the plan.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. C - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. B - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 • Conversations

1. A regulatory question the team can actually discuss - Fictional preparation for an agency meeting: the draft question asks whether the entire development plan is acceptable.

2. Confirming which submission label belongs in the plan - Separate fictional planning meeting: a slide lists NDA/BLA as interchangeable placeholders; the regulatory strategy has not been confirmed.

3. Assigning questions after a response letter - Separate fictional internal exercise: a complete response letter lists three issues, and the team has not yet assigned reviewers.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An unanswered meeting-minutes discrepancy

In a fictional regulatory follow-up, internal notes say a proposed analysis was discussed; the draft summary says it was agreed. No final agency minutes are available. Conduct a call to request a precise wording review before circulation tomorrow.

Role A: Regulatory coordinator: identify the discrepancy and request review of the specific sentence.

Role B: Clinical representative: explain the internal recollection without claiming confirmed agreement.

Possible opening: Our notes record discussion, but the summary says agreement; could you review that distinction today?

Success checks

- Identify the exact wording needing review.
- Distinguish internal recollection from confirmed agency feedback.
- Agree an owner and a realistic response time without inventing approval.

Add a complication: A project sponsor asks you to circulate the stronger version immediately.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Clinical Trial Design, Protocols, GCP, and Operations

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

Two trial documents give different visit-window descriptions. A coordinator is asked which one to use but has not confirmed the controlling version.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: Protocol, Randomization, Informed consent, Protocol deviation.

Model response

The documents appear inconsistent. Which approved version governs this activity? I'll raise the discrepancy through the study process and request clarification before communicating a definitive instruction.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. B - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. A - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. Which visit window controls? - Fictional trial coordination call: two documents describe different visit windows, and the controlling version is unconfirmed.

2. A consent discussion is not a completed consent record - Separate fictional training case: a tracker says consent discussed, while a meeting agenda says ready for randomization.

3. Allocation wording in a recruitment briefing - Separate fictional recruitment rehearsal: a draft describes randomization as the coordinator choosing the most suitable study group.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Remote or on-site visit?

A fictional trial calendar labels a follow-up remote, while a training checklist says on-site. The participant has not been contacted, and the applicable protocol version is unknown. Discuss how to obtain a reliable scheduling instruction.

Role A: Site scheduler: ask focused questions about the visit type and controlling document.

Role B: Trial operations specialist: acknowledge what is unknown and take responsibility for verification.

Possible opening: Before I contact the participant, could we confirm whether this visit is remote or on-site?

Success checks

- Do not treat the most recent edit as proof of authority.
- Name the document and visit details requiring confirmation.
- Agree who returns the verified instruction before participant contact.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests using the calendar because it was edited most recently.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Endpoints, Estimands, Statistics, Data Readouts, and Clinical Meaning

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A trial slide highlights a secondary endpoint while the primary endpoint result needs explanation. The audience may mistake the highlighted result for the main study conclusion.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: Primary endpoint, Secondary endpoint, Estimand, Confidence interval.

Model response

Let's state the primary endpoint result clearly and identify the secondary analysis as such. The presentation should explain what each result supports and any limits on interpretation.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. A - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. C - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 · Conversations

1. The highlighted endpoint is not the primary result - Fictional trial-slide review: a secondary endpoint is highlighted, while the primary endpoint result needs explanation.
2. A precise number with an imprecise estimate - Separate fictional analysis rehearsal: an estimated difference is four units with a confidence interval from minus two to ten; clinical importance has not been assessed.
3. Two analyses answer different questions - Separate fictional methods discussion: two trial analyses handle treatment discontinuation differently; neither result is supplied in the exercise.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A subgroup headline without context

A fictional trial summary highlights one subgroup from an exploratory analysis. The overall primary endpoint result is available elsewhere but is not included in the summary. No interaction analysis is supplied. Discuss a responsible spoken introduction.

Role A: Medical communications lead: qualify the subgroup statement and request the missing context.

Role B: Study statistician: explain why the subgroup alone cannot establish a different treatment effect.

Possible opening: This is an exploratory subgroup finding, and we need the overall primary result beside it.

Success checks

- Identify the exploratory status.
- Avoid claiming a subgroup difference that has not been established.
- Agree which primary-result and uncertainty information must accompany the statement.

Add a complication: The presenter asks you to describe the subgroup as the patients who definitely benefit.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Pharmacovigilance, Safety Signals, Risk-Benefit, and Label Updates

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

CASE

A team member receives a report of a possible adverse event. Key details are incomplete, and the team has a defined safety-reporting process.

Teach this move

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

Vocabulary to check: AE, SAE, Signal detection, Risk-benefit.

Model response

I've received a report that needs review through the safety process. Here are the details available and the information still missing. Please confirm receipt; I have not determined causality or classification.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Second-round challenge

The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Language-check answers

1. C - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check. It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.
2. B - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct? This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

05 · Conversations

1. Passing an incomplete event report - Fictional safety-reporting exercise: a possible adverse event has been reported with incomplete details; the team has a defined reporting process.
2. Severe wording does not settle seriousness - Separate fictional safety intake: a caller described an event as severe; hospitalization and other seriousness information are unknown.
3. A cluster passed to signal review - Separate fictional surveillance meeting: three reports describe a similar event, but duplicate status and exposure information have not been checked.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A reporter corrects the event date

A fictional safety case is already assigned to reviewer Mina. The reporter now says the recorded event date was a transcription error but cannot recall the correct date. Practice handing over this correction without deleting the history or inventing a replacement.

Role A: Medical information specialist: transfer the correction and identify the remaining uncertainty.

Role B: Safety reviewer Mina: confirm receipt and explain who coordinates further clarification.

Possible opening: The reporter has withdrawn the recorded date, but a replacement date is still unknown.

Success checks

- Separate the contact date from the unknown event date.
- Preserve the original report and correction through the case process.
- Confirm the receiving owner and next follow-up responsibility.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests using the first contact date as the event date to avoid an empty field.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

CMC, CGMP, Quality Events, Manufacturing, and Supply

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

A quality review identifies missing documentation in a batch record. A manager asks whether the batch can be described as fully reviewed.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: CMC, Batch record, OOS, CAPA.

Model response

The documentation review is still open. I'll report the missing items and their review status. We should not describe the batch review as complete until the responsible quality team confirms it.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. B - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. A - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 • Conversations

1. A batch review with missing documentation - Fictional quality meeting: documentation is missing from a batch record, and a manager asks whether review is complete.

2. An OOS investigation is not a release decision - Separate fictional quality exercise: one test result is recorded as OOS, the investigation is open, and no disposition is authorized.

3. CAPA implementation versus demonstrated effectiveness - Separate fictional CAPA review: a revised batch-record checklist is in use, but the planned effectiveness check has not occurred.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A supplier certificate arrives unread

In a fictional CMC supply meeting, the missing supplier certificate has arrived for lot L8. Quality has not reviewed it, and disposition remains pending. Discuss what changed and what did not change in the lot's status.

Role A: Materials coordinator: report receipt accurately without implying release.

Role B: Quality reviewer: clarify the remaining document check and take responsibility for the next update.

Possible opening: The certificate for L8 has arrived, but receipt is not the same as completed quality review.

Success checks

- Distinguish document receipt from review and disposition.
- Avoid assuming the certificate is acceptable before assessment.
- Agree who communicates the next verified status.

Add a complication: A planner asks to change the availability indicator to confirmed immediately.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Labeling, Medical Affairs, Promotion Review, and Compliance Boundaries

State a concern respectfully and propose a practical route forward.

CASE

A draft promotional slide uses stronger benefit language than the approved material supplied for review.

Teach this move

Acknowledge the goal without pretending agreement. Name the specific problem and its implication, then ask a focused question or propose a next step. Be direct when a safety or ethical boundary requires it.

Vocabulary to check: Prescribing information, Fair balance, MLR, Scientific exchange.

Model response

The proposed wording goes beyond the material we have been asked to use. Could we revise it to match the approved claim and send the change through the appropriate review process?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence identifies a testable concern about the proposal. It leaves room for a constructive response.

Second-round challenge

The other person repeats the request more firmly. Restate the specific concern calmly and explain the appropriate next route.

Language-check answers

1. A - The proposal assumes the review is complete; the record shows it is still open. It connects the concern to a specific assumption and record.
2. C - Could we resolve the missing approval before confirming the plan? It names the unresolved condition and a practical next step.

05 · Conversations

1. A stronger adjective than the reviewed material - Fictional promotional review: a draft slide makes a stronger benefit claim than the supplied approved material.
2. Scientific exchange is not a label for any slide - Separate fictional conference preparation: a commercial deck contains unreviewed exploratory findings; its owner proposes calling the deck scientific exchange.
3. A risk panel lost in a smaller format - Separate fictional design review: resizing a promotional panel has made the supplied risk text unreadable; no replacement layout is approved.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A testimonial asks for a stronger promise

A fictional promotional video draft includes a speaker saying the product always works. The supplied approved material contains no universal benefit claim. Discuss a revision request before recording; no replacement statement has been reviewed.

Role A: Production coordinator: explain the recording constraint and ask for usable reviewed wording.

Role B: Medical reviewer: challenge the absolute claim and propose the review route.

Possible opening: The word always promises more than our supplied material supports, so this line needs review before recording.

Success checks

- Identify the specific unsupported promise.
- Avoid treating a testimonial label as an automatic exemption.
- Agree to obtain reviewed wording without inventing a new benefit claim.

Add a complication: The speaker says the sentence is a personal opinion and therefore needs no review.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Market Access, RWE, Launch Readiness, Biosimilars, and Lifecycle Management

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

CASE

A market-access presentation combines trial findings and observational data without identifying the different study designs.

Teach this move

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

Vocabulary to check: HEOR, Formulary, RWD, RWE.

Model response

Let's label the evidence sources separately. The trial and observational study answer different questions and have different limitations. That distinction will help the audience interpret the findings accurately.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Second-round challenge

Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Language-check answers

1. C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed. This gives the meaning in familiar words.
2. B - How would you describe the next step in your own words? An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

05 • Conversations

1. Trial findings beside observational evidence - Fictional market-access rehearsal: trial findings and observational data appear together without study-design labels.

2. A formulary decision is not a universal access promise - Separate fictional launch meeting: one organization's formulary listing is confirmed, while patient-level access conditions have not been reviewed.

3. Database size versus a usable comparison - Separate fictional RWE planning discussion: access to a database of 50,000 routinely collected patient records is confirmed, but completeness of the proposed outcome and comparator variables is unknown.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Launch activity versus access outcome

A fictional launch dashboard records twelve payer meetings but no formulary decisions yet. A slide calls the meetings twelve access wins. Discuss how to explain the activity and the unconfirmed outcome in a short leadership conversation.

Role A: Launch operations lead: explain what the twelve meetings measure.

Role B: Market-access director: ask which evidence would support a confirmed access outcome.

Possible opening: We completed twelve payer meetings; that is an activity count, not twelve confirmed formulary decisions.

Success checks

- Separate completed meetings from formulary outcomes.
- Do not invent payer decisions or coverage conditions.
- Agree a concise label and an owner for tracking decisions.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to keep wins because the dashboard has no space for caveats.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Pharmaceutical English

Professional audience: clinical development, regulatory affairs, pharmacovigilance, quality, CMC, manufacturing, medical affairs, market access, and compliance teams

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Lesson 01: Drug Development Strategy, Unmet Need, TPP, and Evidence Logic

Original fictional case: A development slide describes an early laboratory result as evidence that a product will benefit patients. Clinical benefit has not been established.

Language workshop: Match certainty to evidence

Communication goal: Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

Language guidance: Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The available evidence shows ... / This may indicate ..., but ... / We have not yet established whether ...

Vocabulary: Indication: Disease, condition, or patient population for which a product is intended or approved. / MOA: Mechanism of action; how the product is understood to produce a biological effect. / TPP: Target product profile describing desired product attributes and evidence needs. / IND: Investigational new drug application allowing clinical investigation in humans in the United States.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The result supports further investigation in this laboratory setting. It does not establish patient benefit. I'll revise the wording to distinguish the early finding from the clinical questions still to be tested.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.
2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.
3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.
4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.
5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Pharmaceutical English

Professional audience: clinical development, regulatory affairs, pharmacovigilance, quality, CMC, manufacturing, medical affairs, market access, and compliance teams

Scope: Fictional language practice for professional communication. Clinical, safety, regulatory, and patient-care decisions follow qualified supervision and current local procedures.

Lesson 01: Drug Development Strategy, Unmet Need, TPP, and Evidence Logic

Original fictional case: A development slide describes an early laboratory result as evidence that a product will benefit patients. Clinical benefit has not been established.

Language workshop: Match certainty to evidence

Communication goal: Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

Language guidance: Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The available evidence shows ... / This may indicate ..., but ... / We have not yet established whether ...

Vocabulary: Indication: Disease, condition, or patient population for which a product is intended or approved. / MOA: Mechanism of action; how the product is understood to produce a biological effect. / TPP: Target product profile describing desired product attributes and evidence needs. / IND: Investigational new drug application allowing clinical investigation in humans in the United States.

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.
2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.
3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.
4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.
5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level